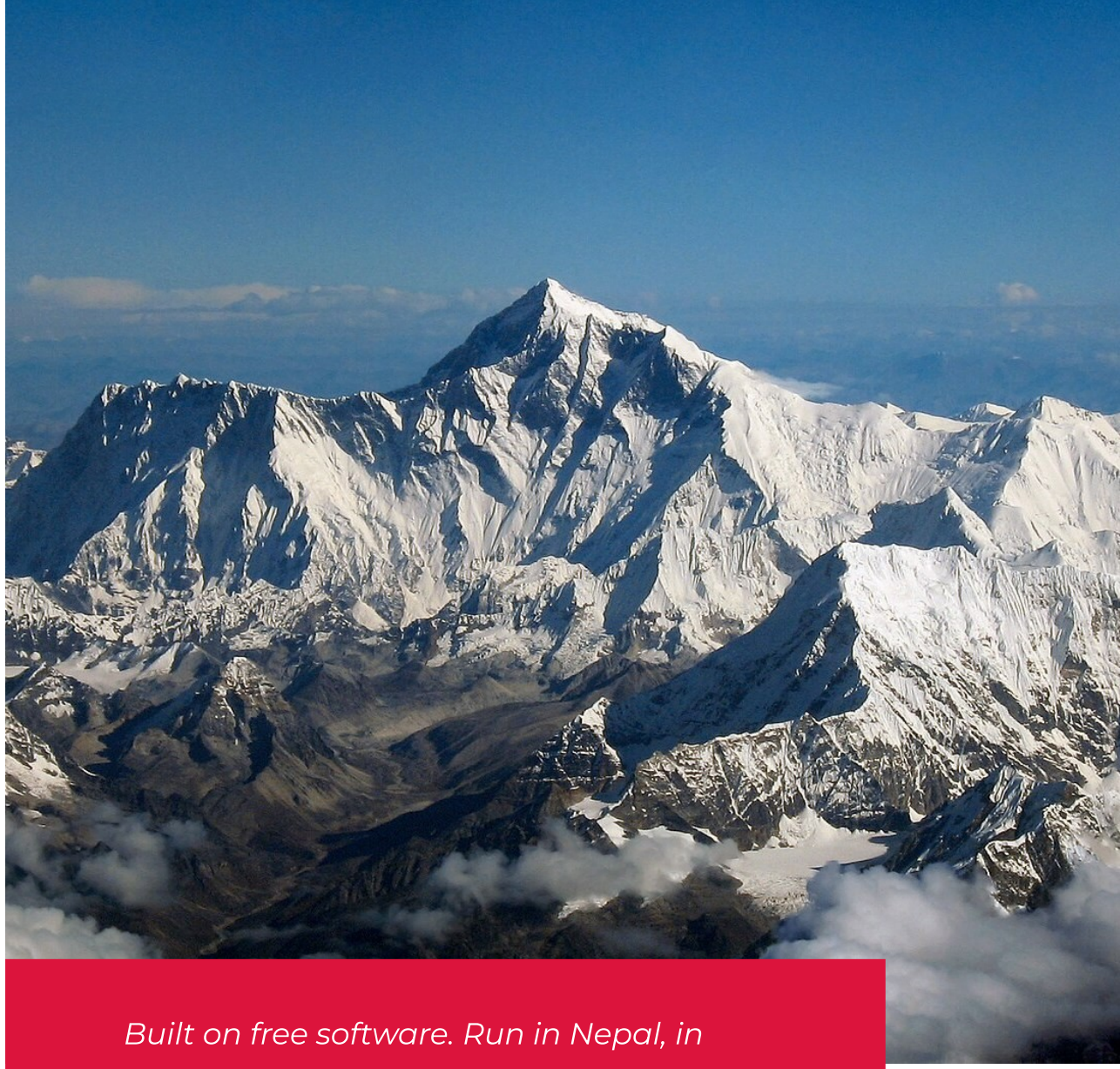
Nepal OS

One free, Nepali-first operating system for all of government

नेपाल ओएस: सरकारका लागि स्वतन्त्र, नेपाली-प्रथम अपरेटिङ सिस्टम

Proposal · Prototype · 2026



Built on free software. Run in Nepal, in Nepali, for every ministry.

The problem today

Three issues that every ministry shares



Licence costs

Paying every year for proprietary desktops and office suites.



Vendor dependence

Foreign companies control updates, data and roadmaps.



Legacy fonts

Many files are still in non-Unicode Preeti: hard to search, share and archive.

Each problem has the same answer: a free, open system that Nepal manages itself.

The model: EU OS

Europe's public sector already has a working example. Nepal OS follows the same approach, on a base built for long, stable use.



What we copy

The method, not the code: test a free desktop, package it and manage it centrally.



01. EU OS

Community-led proof of concept for the EU public sector.
Fedora Linux, KDE Plasma, bootable containers.
Not an official EU project.

02. Nepal OS

The same approach, on Debian stable.
Tested, packaged and centrally managed.
No new kernel, no fork.

What's inside: ready for Nepali work on day one



Office suite

LibreOffice, with a Nepali interface and Nepali spellcheck.



Fonts

Kalimati (default), Preeti for legacy files plus a converter, and Noto Sans Devanagari.



Keyboards

Romanized and Traditional Nepali layouts, with a one-click switch.



Nepali by default

Bikram Sambat calendar, Kathmandu time, and Himalaya and temple wallpapers.

One image, every ministry

Every computer gets the same signed image. At install, a ministry code such as mof, moha or moest sets the ministry's name in Nepali and English, its logo, login screen, wallpaper, About page, bookmarks and update server.

One image

Same for all

One signed image for all of government.

Any ministry

Set at install

A short code gives each ministry its own identity.



Mass deployment

Three steps take one tested image to every government computer, with updates under central control.



1

Automatic install

From USB or network boot. The ministry code is the only input.

2

National mirror

A national package mirror in a government data centre.

3

Staged updates

Central IT, then a pilot ministry, then all of government. Nightly security fixes; rollback to a snapshot.



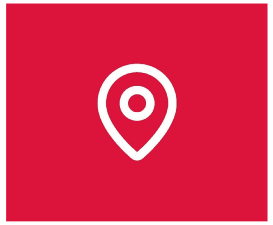
No telemetry

No usage reports and no phone-home to any vendor.



Open source

All code is open and can be audited.



Stays in Nepal

Updates and data stay on infrastructure in Nepal.

Security and sovereignty

Government keeps control of its own computers and its own data.

These three rules apply to every ministry, from the first pilot onward.

Risks and responses

RISK



Font licensing

Kalimati and Preeti need clear permission for use and sharing.



Translation gaps

Some programs are not yet fully translated into Nepali.



Old printers and apps

Some printers and Windows-only programs may not work.

RESPONSE



Written permission

Ask for written permission for Kalimati and Preeti; Noto is a free fallback.



Translation drive

A translation drive with Nepali universities.



Test list and options

A hardware test list, plus web or virtual-machine options.

Twelve months to version 1.0

Five steps, from the first packages to a phased rollout.



Months 1–2

Licensing, repository and first packages.

Months 3–4

Keyboard and translation testing; pilot on about 20 machines.

Months 5–7

Automatic install, ministry profiles, 2–3 pilot ministries.

Months 8–10

Fixes, guides and IT training.

Months 11–12

Version 1.0 and phased rollout.

The ask

Two decisions let the pilot begin.

1. Approve a pilot

In one or more ministries.

2. Name a central owner

For the base image and the ministry profiles.

